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~ npx good-first-issue

? Choose a project:
Apollo - A community building flexible open source tools for GraphQL.
> Babel - Babel is a compiler for writing next generation JavaScript.
BigTestjs.io - A Suite of JavaScript libraries and framework extensions to help you
answer the question.
Create React App - Set up a modern web app by running one command.
Firefox Debugger - The Firefox debugger that works anywhere.
Docusaurus - Easy to maintain open source documentation websites.
(Move up and down to reveal more choices)

```

Fig. 4: Command type in and project selection options

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? Choose a project: Babel - Babel is a compiler for writing next generation JavaScript.
[@octokit/rest] `const Octokit = require("@octokit/rest")` is deprecated. Use `const
{ Octokit } = require("@octokit/rest")` instead

Good First Issue in Babel:
- Title: injecting external-helpers in a node app
- Repository: babel/babel
- Issue: #7357
- Status: open
- Assigned to: unassigned!

Start now: https://github.com/babel/babel/issues/7357

```

Fig. 5: Example of a good first issue in Babel (Credit: OSI 2021)

developer acts as a central point of communication of a project. All this can be regarded as the first circle of communication.

Outside the immediate circle, a developer is expected to interact with different people outside their project or company, especially with bigger development or open source communities. Doing so exposes the developer to different opinions and constructive feedback, which is very important for improving and building key technical skills.

More contributions = More visibility

As a member of the open source community and by contributing to open source projects, your profile will get more visibility. That means your professional profile will get more desirable views and requests from people looking to hire techies/developers.

Although this is a suggestion and

not mandatory, it gives you an edge as it allows you to easily showcase your work results. And if lucky, your open source work can help you skip some of the tricky parts of interviews upon selection for a tech job.

Ground rules before contribution

1. Do not fear making your first contribution. You do not have to be an expert to begin.
2. Even if you have not written a line of code in your entire life, there are still different ways to contribute to open source. You do not necessarily have to learn to code.
3. You do not need to ask anyone's permission before contributing to an open source project. But it is nice to chat with the project maintenance team to have a better chance of your contribution being accepted.
4. Always start small rather than making a big contribution. If you do not know the people maintain-

ing the project, their purpose for the project, and their expectations from your contribution, chances are your contribution will get rejected. You will get less frustrated if you decide to work small and get refused instead of working big for several weeks.

5. Never give up if your first try does not work out. Learn from the feedback to your contribution and make relevant improvements to your style of work. Your contribution will surely get accepted next time.

Steps to make first contribution

Choose a project. If you do not know where to start, there are some open source tools you can use. One of them is a website called First Contributions where you can find a lot of open source projects with specific issues that are friendly for first-time contributions. Simply go through them and select.

On selecting a project, you will be taken to the GitHub page of the project into the Issues section that is filtered with good first issues for first-time contributors. Go through the different issues and select whichever one interests you.

After selecting the issue, read the general description to know what you are expected to do. If someone has already assigned himself/herself to the project, look for any other issue to work upon.

If you do not wish to go through GitHub, there is another method for which Node.js should be installed in your machine. Type `npx good-first-issue` in the terminal and it will give you a list of available projects. For instance, if you choose to contribute to Babel, a random issue will be automatically picked. To start working on the issue, go to the given GitHub link.

Before making any contribution, check whether the project has been actively maintained over time so that your contribution request gets